

Regular Meeting
April 9, 2018
School Committee Meeting
Council Chambers
Amended

The regular meeting of the Medford School Committee was called to order by Vice Chair Mea Mustone in the City Hall Council Chambers at 7:23 p.m. Those present were Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot and Superintendent Belson. Mayor Burke was absent. Medford High School Student Representative Sebastian Tringale was also present.

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Mr. Ruggiero that the minutes of March 19, 2018 be approved:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Kreatz that the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved:

Voted: That the Bills/Transfer of Funds be approved.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Burke

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau that the Payrolls be approved:

Voted: That the Payrolls be approved

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot
Nay: 0
Absent: 1 Burke

Ms. Kreatz presented a brief overview of the Medford/Malden Lodge of Elks Scholarship awards and she also reviewed the March vouchers that were recently paid.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot thanked Ms. Kreatz for the reports. Ms. DiBenedetto commented that she likes the secretary's reports. She asked Superintendent Belson what is the status of Bistro 489. Superintendent Belson answered that a few things still have to be adjusted. They are planning to have a press conference there on Friday regarding the Krystle Campell fund. Mr. Ruseau asked if the issue with the prep table has been solved. The Superintendent answered yes it has arrived.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot that report was accepted and placed on file.

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. Mustone briefly gave an overview of the buildings and grounds subcommittee meeting held on March 22, 2018. Below are the meeting minutes:

The meeting was called to order by Chairperson Mea Mustone at 7:00 p.m. in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School. Sub-Committee members in attendance: Mea Mustone, Erin DiBenedetto, and Kathy Kreatz. Superintendent Roy Belson and Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell were also present.

All rose to salute the Flag.

The following persons were in attendance:

Principals: Paul D'Alleva, Suzanne Galusi, Kirk Johnson, Kathleen Kay, Diane Guarino, Brian Twomey

Administrators: John McLaughlin, Toni Vento, Ian Charles

MTA President: Charlene Douglas

Parents and Community Members: Kathy Kreatz and Paulette Van der Kloot, Kristina Collazo, Kristen Glionna, Alicia Hunt, Melanie McLaughlin, Amanda O'Learyk Jenna LaBissononieve, Kevin Costello, Bill Cofill

Chairperson Mustone explained that the Buildings and grounds Sub-Committee was assigned by the Mayor to review and discuss security measures in our schools. That this topic would be a standing item on the Buildings and Grounds sub-committee agenda. The Superintendent provided two recent news articles for the sub-committee to consider as context for the discussion:

- *Schools Are Safer than 90's* (Northeastern News)
- *Threat of Shootings Turns School Security Into a Growth Industry* (New York Times)

The Superintendent also provided a copy of the Medford Public Schools Building Security Check list and the Department of Justice 5 Step Response Outline. Chairperson Mustone then asked each of the school principals to review their respective current safety measures:

Medford High School Complex – Ian Charles

- Re-assigned personnel to cover the doors of entry in the morning (beginning at 6:30). This includes the front, vocational, west courtyard, and pool entrance doors
- Positioned security and monitors to ensure front door coverage (requiring buzzed entry) in the evenings until 9 pm as well as extended camera coverage
- Positioned security and doors monitors to covers the building during the weekends and special events
- Reviewed and practiced all emergency procedures with students and faculty including Stay in Place, Lock Down and Evacuation during a lunch-block

- Created a Student Safety Committee to empower students to voice concerns and engage in safety conversations.
- Utilized 2 Professional Development workshops (1 full day, and 1 early release day) focused on school security, including an introduction to ALICE
- Scheduling a joint PTO/MHS Administration Parent forum regarding school safety in April (date TBA)
- Have held numerous Leadership Team security discussions and planning

Andrews Middle School – Paul D’Alleva

- All Interior and Exterior Cameras have been updated or newly replaced. An extra camera was installed to gain better line of sight of people entering the front door.
- All doors have been inspected and fixed for any locking or opening issues.
- There is now a door monitor checking ID's as you enter first initial front doors of the building. All visitors must check in and out when entering and leaving the complex.
- All emergency procedures were reviewed with staff,
- Utilized 2 Professional Development workshops (1 full day, and 1 early release day) focused on school security, including an introduction to ALICE.
- Coffee with the Principal was rescheduled earlier with Parents to discuss new security measures.
- Discussions with Leadership teams have been ongoing for review and improve security measures.

McGlynn Elementary and Middle School – Diane Guarino

- Utilized two professional day workshops where we focused on school security.
- Held several Leadership team meetings to review and update our emergency planning procedures.
- Practiced our emergency procedures with students and faculty and solicited their feedback to improve the procedures.
- At the April 4th faculty meeting at the McGlynn Middle School, we will present out to faculty a revised emergency planning procedure based upon their feedback. In the days that follow, the faculty will review the plans with each of their classes and then drill the procedures as a school community.
- The attached Google document is the work in progress for the McGlynn complex.

Brooks School – Suzanne Galusi

- All staff are using the main entrance on Auburn Street to access the building each morning. We are no longer buzzing them in on the first floor.
- All visitors must announce who they are and where they are going to be allowed entry (buzzed) into the building
- My secretary is keeping an additional calendar for visitors to double check and ensure people at the door have a reason to be there
- Continued and ongoing professional development for staff

Columbus School – Kathy Kay

- ALL staff and families can only enter through the main front door;
- ALL families must wait outside for their child to be dismissed at the end of the day and from after school clubs;
- ALL staff and students have been reminded NOT to ever let people in ANY door; ALL visitors are directed to the front door & door monitor;
- ALL visitors MUST announce where and/or to whom they are here to visit before entry;
- Teachers give a list of expected visitors to the secretary and door monitor so we know who is expected;
- Re-confirming with the PTO that volunteers must “man” the doors at all evening events to let people into the building. Once you arrive you stay in the school until you leave.

For the future we will practice:

- Lock downs during lunch and recess periods;
- Evacuation of building drills to a separate location.

Roberts School – Kirk Johnson

- Completed February 26, 2018 Professional Development Day: Review Safety Protocol(s)
- Completed March 21, 2018 Professional Development Day: Introduction of Safety Program to be reviewed by the Medford Public Schools
- Staff Entry in the morning has been adjusted to a locked door entry
- Daily appointment(s) list is given to the Door Monitor each day
- Reinforce parents / guardians to not enter the building before and/or during dismissal time

Curtis Tufts – Brian Twomey

Overall building is safe but there is a need for a new front door and PA system. Bell system is used.

SEPAC Chairperson Melanie stressed the need to have well thought thru plans and procedures to assist students with disabilities.

Health Services Supervisor Toni Vento explained that several measures were in place including the availability of evacuation sleds and other equipment.

The Superintendent explained that each building has emergency plans in place and that each building has some different needs based upon construction of the facility. Also that each emergency is situation specific.

Buildings and Grounds Director John McLaughlin reported that all buildings have been checked for locked doors.

MTA union President Charlene Douglas shared some teacher association concerns. The MTA will provide guidance to our planning as well. She raised concerns about ALICE training, costs, and use.

The discussion produced multiple measures that should be considered going forward.
The ideas included:

1. Re-evaluate STARS (School Threat Assessment and Response System) of the NEMLEC (Northeastern Massachusetts Law Enforcement Council) is a regional collaboration focused on enhancing school safety and security. STARS is a specialized law enforcement unit that works with local police chiefs (who are NEMLEC members), school superintendents and fire chiefs to support districts' emergency management efforts involving threats. STARS is organized around teams made up of highly trained personnel. Team members include representatives from police, school and fire departments as well as an expert in mental health. The STARS teams assist local districts to: develop, implement, practice and evaluate school safety plans; identify threats and/or causes of violence; and create solutions and strategies to address causes of violence. In addition, the STARS team will respond to calls from a district for assistance during crises or critical incidents. As appropriate, the team may access specialized equipment such as portable metal detectors and x-ray machines, explosives detection, canines, or other incident command equipment. Finally, the STARS provides technical experts who work with local leaders to help restore a sense of normalcy to a school community so education may continue.
2. Magnetic strips for doors <https://www.amazon.com/pack-security-magnetic-lockdown-classrooms/dp/B07B6849RB>
3. Additional adjustment counselors
4. Safety committee in each school
5. Classroom keys in main office for substitutes
6. Numbers on doors
7. Additional Medford Police Officers assigned to schools
8. Additional social and emotional training for all staff
9. Additional walkie talkies
10. Keyless entry for staff and faculty (Tap cards)
11. Security training for before school staff, after school staff and early childhood staff
12. Standing security agenda item on buildings and grounds subcommittee include EL and SEPAC representatives
13. Information for new students who start midyear
14. Emergency kits for lock down situations
15. Suggestions for children during a lockdown stated in their IEP

Chairperson Mustone thanked all for their participation and ideas.
The meeting was adjourned at 8:33 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,
Mea Mustone
Chairperson

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto would like suggestions moved to building and grounds to be implemented. Superintendent Belson said that it is the intent to do a cost analysis and feasibility study for each item. Ms. Kreatz commented that the vocational school was not included in the meeting. She said that the vocational door is locked and should be operational which means putting a security monitor there. Superintendent Belson said that we are spending about \$3,000 for security monitors per week. We can't cover every door but will research the cost. Ms. DiBenedetto said that a monitor is at the pool door. She suggested putting them in the vocational office during the school day. The Superintendent said that we must make a choice. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for a count of how many people come in doors for a week.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Kreatz for a study of the relative traffic pattern at the pool and vocational doors for one week:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot to take agenda item out of order:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Scholastic Art Award

Director of Fine Arts Tony Szykniej presented the report. He stated that four Medford students have won recognition in the 2018 Massachusetts Regional Scholastic Art Awards. MHS Senior Julia Talbot (Gold Key, Comic Art, *Moon Kingdom*), senior Wendy St. Jules (Silver Key, Mixed Media, *Black Out*), sophomore Frances Flood (Honorable Mention, Photography, *One Tree Hill*) and McGlynn Middle School 8th grader Nertha Richard (Honorable Mention, Photography, *Different Eyes, Same Soul*), received awards from the longest running, most prestigious national art competition in the country. In December 2017, students in grades 7-12 submitted artwork for competition in a broad range of art disciplines. All works were evaluated through blind adjudication, first on a regional level by more than 100 affiliates of the Scholastic Art Awards and then nationally by an impressive panel of creative industry experts. Julia's work, a comic art entry that was on display at Tufts University, won a regional gold key and advanced to national judging in New York where it was awarded a Gold Medal. She will be honored for her accomplishment at Carnegie Hall in June. The students were presented with school committee awards.

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Scholastic Writing

Dr. Nicole Chiesa presented the report. She reported that The Boston Globe Scholastic Writing Awards are an important opportunity for students to be recognized for their creative talents. This year, with over 2,500 Massachusetts students entering the Boston Globe Scholastic Writing Awards, I am very pleased to announce that Medford had ten Scholastic Writing Award winners: two receiving Gold Key awards, one receiving a Silver Key award, and seven receiving Honorable Mention awards. Some students were repeat winners from 2017. This year also represents the third time middle school students – four in total - earned a Boston Globe Scholastic Writing award. We are very proud of all middle and high school students who entered and allowed their written work to be judged. I would also like to thank all participating teachers including high school teachers David Ambrose, Nicole Sanford, Sara Stevens, Max Heinegg, Shawn Morris and Doug Bowen-Flynn as well as McGlynn middle school teacher Kristin Zeckman. These teachers worked with students to produce high quality written products and selflessly devoted extra time outside of regular class time to help students create these very special pieces of work. The 2018 Medford High School Scholastic Writing winners are:

Gold Key

- Kayla Dell’Anno winning in the poetry category for her piece entitled *Perspective*
- Emily Gaddy winning in the personal essay/memoir category for her piece entitled *Letters to a Young Poet*

Silver Key:

- Jacqueline Madigan winning in the personal essay/memoir category for her piece entitled *It All Comes Full Circle*

Honorable Mention:

- Pema Choejung winning in the poetry category for the piece entitled *My Plateau*
- Rachel Elliott winning in the poetry category for the piece entitled *Standard of Stupidity*
- Sumaya Orni winning in the short story category for the piece entitled *Just an Illusion*
- Alyssa Parziale winning in the short story category for the piece entitled *In the Parks*
- Nertha Richard winning in the short story category for the piece entitled *Choices*
- Margaret Tseng winning in the poetry category for the piece entitled *Who I am*
- Meicha Vertilus winning in the personal essay/memoir category for her piece entitled *January 12, 2010*

The students were presented with school committee certificates.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Kreatz the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Ms. Kreatz to revert back to the regular order of business:

Vote:

Yes: 7

No: 0

Absent: 0

Committee of the Whole Meeting – March 29, 2018

The Medford School Committee of the Whole was called to order at 5:00 p.m. on Thursday, March 29, 2018 in the Library Resource Center at Medford High School by Mayor Stephanie M. Burke.

The following members were present: Mayor Burke, Erin DiBenedetto, Kathy Kreatz, Mea Mustone, Michael Ruggiero, Paul Ruseau and Paulette Van der Kloot. Also present were Superintendent Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson and Director of Finance and Administration Kirsteen Patterson

All rose to salute the flag.

Mayor Burke announced that the Superintendent's Search Committee has recommended four finalists for public/School Committee interviews. The individuals recommended are as follows:

- Marice Edouard-Vincent Ed.D
- John Perella Ed.D
- Donna Straight Ed.D
- Thomas Martellone Ed.S

Voted: by the School Committee to accept the recommendation of the Search Committee

Mayor Burke announced that Public Interviews for Superintendent would be held on Monday April 2nd and Wednesday April 4th. There would be two interviews each evening.

Mayor Burke thanked the Search Committee for their diligent work working with MASC to review the applications and interview the semi-finalists.

Mayor Burke stated that the main purpose of tonight's committee of the whole is the review the inquires that were made regarding payroll items identified by member DiBenedetto on March 19, 2018 at a regular meeting.

The Mayor recognized the Superintendent for an overview of the responses from the administration.

The Superintendent identified four reports/documents as follows (see attached)

- Payroll report response – Office of Administration and Finance
- Superintendent's memo of March 28, 2018 on clerical step increases
- Superintendent's memo of March 29, 2018 on past clerical hiring examples

- Collective bargaining agreement between Medford School Committee and Medford Educational Secretaries Association (MESA)

Mayor Burke asked that the Superintendent begin the presentation. Member DiBenedetto objected to the discussion of the March 29th memo since it was only available at this meeting. Mayor Burke determined that the presentation go forward since the memo was informational (see attached).

The Superintendent read and discussed the memos and documents key points including the following:

- The collective bargaining agreement between the union and the School Committee provides the Superintendent with flexibility to place newly hired secretaries (Administrative Assistants) on the salary schedule up to Step 3. The term newly hired is interpreted
- The union can grieve a contract violation. No grievance was so filed.
- Equity and fairness with regard to comparable positions was considered. Hiring is competitive
- Budgets are plans not absolutes. There are multiple changes each year.
- The School Committee should not waive its management rights.
- The issues were discussed with the Union Presidents in the fall of 2017
- There is substantial past practice

Mr. Ruggiero asked for the definition of step increases and COLA. It was explained by the Superintendent. Mr. Ruggiero also asked what newly hired meant. The Superintendent explained that it is a broader term and reflects a range of years. The issue has not been grieved. Newly hired in their role for those that were in other positions has been acceptable. COLAs for collective bargaining units are across the board. Non unit clerical were voted on June 19th on the same evening that the budget was approved.

Mr. Ruggiero asked if union members were aware. The Superintendent answered that there were meeting in the fall of 2017 and with the Presidents of the unions.

Ms. DiBenedetto said she contacted Michael Coogan of the AFSME union and he claimed that he was not notified.

Superintendent disagreed. Mr. Coogan came on board in the fall. Meetings were held and notification to the Presidents was sufficient.

Ms. DiBenedetto raised the issue that one of the Presidents was a beneficiary of an adjustment.

Maria Arcieri, Co-President testified that the matter was discussed and that union members were aware in the fall. Also that there were union meetings. Further, that no grievance was filed.

The Superintendent reminded the School Committee that unions do file grievances when they are concerned.

Ms. Arcieri said that the membership had a mixed reaction to the changes. The union knew about it as early as October.

Ms. DiBenedetto asked a series of questions regarding the term “newly hired.”

The Superintendent answered that he viewed the term more broadly and that there was past practice and no grievance.

The Superintendent asked Director Patterson to present her report to the School Committee.

Director Patterson began by citing the four general points contained in her report (see attached report).

Director Patterson proceeded to explain each of the twenty-one inquiries that were made at the March 19, 2018 meeting.

Ms. DiBenedetto asked for clarification on the following items in her report: #2, 5, and 9.

The key issues raised by Ms. DiBenedetto are as follows:

- Items in the budget book do not match one for one with the payroll items raised
- Did everyone get the COLA and the 2.5 doesn't match up with the budget book
- What about a stipend paid to A.G.

Answers were provided to the questions raised as follows:

- The budget is a plan and changes happen throughout the year for multiple reasons.
- The COLA is applied to all and is added to the restructured step if applicable
- The mid-year increase is only multiplied by 13x since it is a half year application (not 26)
- The stipend for A.G. comes from the city budget for webmaster duties.
- There are 200 plus changes each year for a variety of reasons including earned credits, leaves of absence, replacements, new needs etc. Notification to School Committee cannot be on a fluid basis. Educational Reform defined roles

The School Committee and the administration engaged in a robust discussion of these issues. Key points and decisions are as follows:

- Budget is a plan and changes happen all year. Financial reports will keep budget on track.
- Revenue accounts are complex. There will be an annual reporting in the fall of the previous year's transactions in October when the End of Year state report is filed.
- Interim reports on special revolving accounts can be made to help the committee make program and policy decisions.
- When budget book is produced there will be a status report on awarded COLAs to help School Committee track salaries.
- The annual audit will be provided to the School Committee
- To the extent possible reports will be delivered in a machine readable electronic format

- There will be a training session for members on collective bargaining and other budget matters
- Management rights need to be respected and preserved by the School Committee
- There is a need to be cognizant of the respective roles of School Committee and Administration. Oversight not micromanagement is essential. There needs to be trust
- Good data at reasonable intervals will help policy and practice.

The meeting was adjourned at 6:25 p.m.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto requested that payroll reports be provided to the committee twice a year. Ms. DiBenedetto asked for clarification of the term “newly hired.” She also asked if the COLA increase was given to secretaries before or after the budget book was prepared.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to receive biannual payroll reports at the ½ year point and the end of the fiscal year to review payroll data:

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Burke

On the motion of Ms. Kreatz seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Ms. Van der Kloot updated the public on the Superintendent’s search. She reported that at the Committee of the Whole meeting they voted to look into the backgrounds and do site visits for Marice Edouard-Vincent and Thomas Martellone.

Community Participation

Cheryl Rodriguez, 21 Park Street was given permission to speak. Ms. Rodriguez voiced concern that as children get older the bullying on technological devices extends onto many social media sites and it is carried into school. She suggested that the schools implement some type of a program to deal with this type of bullying. She asked if the Michigan Model has this as part of its components. Parents don’t know how to guide their children regarding this. She is very concerned with this problem. She also suggested setting up a committee to explore options and including parents in the group.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot said that she agrees that technology brings whole new level to bullying. She affirmed that a public forum was held on Bullying but review of the policy

needs to be done and next steps need to be set up. Perhaps another public forum could be help. She also suggested that the issue could be sent to the subcommittee on curriculum to review the policy. Mr. Ruggiero asked if there is a report on the number of bullying cases? Superintendent Belson answered that if administrators fill out the form they have a record. Cyber bullying is very intense and very difficult to control. We have discipline reports that are filed with the state annually. Ms. Kreatz suggested implementing a Hotline for bullying. Student Representative Sebastian Tringale commented that the policy is worth updating. Ms. DiBenedetto said it needs to be re-done and updated. She asked if we have staff complete the forms and if central administration reviews them. We need to track not only daily incidents but annual ones. She suggested sending this review to the rules committee.

On the motion of Mr. Ruseau to get the number of reports of forms filled out by schools:
Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Roberts School Principal Johnson gave a quick review of the policy.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero to hold a Committee of the Whole (after the completion of the appointment of Superintendent) to review policy

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Professional Development

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell presented the report. Ms. Caldwell reported that as scheduled the mandated early release day program took place the afternoon\on of March 21st. All teachers and specialists participated in the program. The program for the high school and middle school teachers began at 12:45 pm. The elementary program began at 2:00 pm. Lt. Covino and Det. Giganti facilitate the meeting with an introduction to ALICE. There was an opportunity for teachers to ask questions before breaking into smaller groups for discussion. Data is being collected and reviewed. Once all surveys are collated we will share more detail and comments.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot seconded by Mr. Ruggiero to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0

Absent: 1

Pre Budget Report – English Language Arts

Dr. Nicole Chiesa presented the report.

Overview of Department the English Language Arts department (ELA) is dedicated to supporting all teachers in the district who teach this core academic subject. The ELA curriculum is aligned to the 2017 Massachusetts English Language Arts Curriculum Framework. At the elementary level, instructional materials include Journeys Common Core and additional trade books. At the middle school and high school level, curriculum and instructional materials include Houghton Mifflin's anthologies, periodicals, fictional and informational texts and e-readers. There are twenty eight teachers in the department.

Use of Funding SY 2017-2018

Funding was appropriated for the following:

- Amazon Kindle Fire tablets and storage for these tablets. The Kindle Fires reduce text costs due to a decrease in durability and the use of free books available on the public domain. Additionally, the Kindle Fires allow students to access informational pieces as well as the Commonwealth e-Book collection database that Medford subscribes to.
- Journeys materials that were needed due to a rise in the number of elementary classrooms at various grade levels. This funding was highly instrumental in attaining the appropriate set of Journeys materials for the additional classrooms.
- Response-to-Intervention materials at both the elementary (grade 1) and middle school level.
- Instructional materials at the middle and high schools including periodicals as well as informational and fictional texts.
- General classroom supplies.

Accomplishments of the 2017-2018 SY Year

- Updated the district curriculum based on the newly published state framework for ELA. This work included reviewing current unit curriculum, district curriculum, materials and assessments.
- High school ELA students participated in Boston University's New Noises, the Massachusetts Young Playwrights' Project Festival of ten-minute plays written by Massachusetts high school students.
- Elementary and middle school students participation in mock MCAS exams to establish testing comfort.
- Maintenance of personalized data folders for each 6-12 ELA teacher in order to provide greater access and subsequent analysis of MCAS data.
- Strong Scholastic Writing Awards success, including winners at the middle school level.
- The high school continued to demonstrate great success on the MCAS and Advanced Placement assessments.
- The department continued to grow its collaboration with outside partnerships and opportunities for students.

Requests for Budget 2018-2019 Additional funding of \$2,400 is requested to support Study Island which FY 18 was paid for through grant funding. This grant funding may not be continued this school year.

Discussion:

Ms. DiBenedetto questioned the implementation of RTI. Ms. Caldwell gave an update.

Pre Budget Report – Social Studies

Dr. Nicole Chiesa presented the report. Dr. Chiesa reported that The Medford Public Schools is committed to providing all students with the academic and problem-solving skills essential for personal development, responsible citizenship and life-long learning. There are 26 teachers in the social studies department.

Use of Funding was appropriated for the following:

- Eleventh grade social studies textbooks.
- Online subscriptions
- Replacement textbooks.
- Instructional materials at the middle and high schools including new grade 8 textbooks
- Periodicals
- Textbooks for our new Advanced Placement Human Geography and standard Economics classes
- Funding also supported the numerous authentic learning opportunities including Model United Nations and Mock Trial registration costs as well as the upcoming Royall House visits.

Accomplishments of the 2017-2018 SY Year

- Significant increase in community partnerships for authentic learning opportunities including Veterans Day, National History Day at the middle and high school level, Mock Trial team at the high school, Model United Nations at the middle and high school level and Law Day.
- Increase in senior year classes: This year the Social Studies department added an Advanced Placement Human Geography course and a standard Economics section. The Social Studies department has added and/or reinstated eight senior year classes in the past three years to the twelfth grade curriculum.
- Global Scholars: This program continues to carry on successfully with students engaging with others across the world. Chromebooks support this program to allow for greater collaboration across the grade levels. This year, social studies teacher Frank Zizzo had the opportunity to attend the Global Cities Paris Symposium representing Medford Public Schools

Requests for budget SY 18-19

An additional \$3,000 is requested to support curriculum work that will need to be done when new social studies frameworks are adopted in 2018 by the Massachusetts Department of Elementary and Secondary Education.

On the motion Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Pre Budget – Science

Director of Science Rocco Cieri presented the report.

OVERVIEW OF DEPARTMENT

- Staffing:
 - Middle Schools: 14
 - High School: 14

USE OF FUNDING SY 17/18

- Elementary School Support
- General Supplies and Consumables according to budget

ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Grants:
 - Medford Educational Foundation Grants Support Science
 - Concord Consortium/Grade 8 Weather Unit
- Science Fair:
 - Regional Fair Update
- Tufts Partnerships
 - Reverse Science Fair
 - STEM Ambassadors

REQUESTS FOR BUDGET SY 18/19

- STAFF
 - Funded at FY2018 level;
 - 0.5 additional staff recommended at 9-12 for Chemistry
- 6-12 TEXTBOOK
 - Funded at FY2018 level
- INSTRUCTIONAL
 - Funded at FY2017 level

Discussion:

Much discussion was held regarding the pilot programs that are being tried at the elementary schools. Members offered suggestions on continuation for next year. Mr. Cieri said that a recommendation on the selection of a program would probably come next year.

On the motion Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau the report was accepted and placed on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

Report on Science Fair

Mr. Cieri continued with the report. On April 12, 2018, Medford High School students will be participating in our Annual Medford High School Science & Engineering Fair from 8:30-11:45am in the Science Lecture Hall at Medford High School. The participants are invited from grades 9-12 from *any* program or science/technical class – vocational/technical or high school. In addition, students from the Curtis/Tufts program are invited to participate. Based on classroom presentations, each teacher invites up to three student projects to participate in the High School Fair from among all their classes. In some cases, the students that are invited may be presenting the work of a team from the class. Therefore, the fair represents a select group of students from the entire school community. Students present their research to judges from our community partners as well as to professional scientists and engineers from the area

Region IV Science Fair

The 42nd Region IV Science Fair was held at Somerville High School on March 10th, 2018. Each year, over 100 students from both public and private high schools in the region present their work at this fair to experts. In order to qualify for participation, students must submit a Research Proposal to a State Science Research Committee, which will pre-approve the research project. Then, students can conduct their research and upon completion of their project, they can participate in the fair. Medford High School students participating in this fair were Sarah Abdulkarim (Grade 12), Shubbechha Dhaurali (Grade 11), Albert Farah (Grade 10), and Mary Neguse (Grade 12). This event qualifies the 40 top projects for the State Science and Engineering Fair at MIT on May 3-5, 2018. This year, all four of the Medford High students who participated won an award at the Regional Science and Engineering Fair, and qualified for the upcoming State Science and Engineering Fair at MIT. The Region IV Fair (held March 10) rather than the state MIT fair (held May 2-5) is also a qualifying fair for the Intel International Science and Engineering Fair for Medford students. By placing in 1st or 2nd at the Region IV Fair, students will qualify. Although no Medford students have qualified this year in past years our students have participated (2011, 2013, 2014 – Erica Budina (class of 2014), 2016 – Ann Le (class of 2016)).

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruggiero to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Pre Budget Report – Health Services

OVERVIEW OF THE PROGRAM

Nurse Staff Coverage: Staffing is based upon student enrollment and acuity of student health needs.

- MHS: 3 nurses covering MHS, MVTHS, MEEP program, MVTHS day care, Kids' Corner and New Student Registration

- Andrews MS: 1 nurse
 - ❖ 1 FTE retirement on June 30, 2018
- McGlynn MS: 1.5 nurses
- McGlynn Elementary: 1.5 nurses
- Columbus: 1.6 nurses
- Brooks: 2 nurses
- Roberts: 1.6 nurse
- Curtis-Tufts: 0.4 nurse

USE OF FUNDING:

- Use of funding for SY 2017-18 was consistent with how funds were appropriated.

ACCOMPLISHMENTS:

- Maintenance of a 96.6 % student return to class rate.
- SBIRT training for middle school adjustment and guidance counselors, school nurses and school psychologists.
- 16 Automatic external defibrillators (AED) received.
- School Physician was hired following resignation of Dr. Kristen Goodell.
- Two parent educational forums were implemented.

REQUESTS FOR BUDGET 2018-2019

SPECIAL REQUESTS

- Increase nursing staff by 0.5 FTE to bring the department to 13.1 FTE, allowing re-organization of nursing positions at the Curtis-Tufts High School and Andrews Middle School.

Discussion:

Ms. Van der Kloot asked when the date is for the anxiety forum. Ms. Vento answered May 9th from 6:30 – 8:30pm at the McGlynn School.

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

On the motion of Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Mr. Ruseau to add to the agenda the next steps for the transition of the Superintendent and to prepare a list of upcoming retirements. . Vote:

Yes: 6
No: 0
Absent: 1

Report on Medford Public Schools After School Programs

Superintendent Belson reported that this report details enrollment and staffing and more completely describes the challenges of the program. At the end of this school year Shelly Gross will be retiring after many productive years as the head of this program. Shelly has done an outstanding job building and managing this aspect of our school system. As we go forward we are looking at a re-organization of early childhood programs including the management of before and after school programming. Part of our solution to expanding the capacity of the before and after school programs is to identify a program director who will concentrate totally on these aspects of our school system. The need to hire, train, retain and supervise staff is a major undertaking. Also new program development is necessary to optimize the value of these elements of our school system. Our goal will be to expand to meet the needs of all who require coverage with a high quality program. We expect to have a proposal before the School Committee in May to move this forward.

Discussion:

Mr. Ruggiero asked how many families have applied for next year? Superintendent Belson answered that applications are still coming in and as soon as they are compiled he will get them the information. Ms. DiBenedetto asked if they will receive an update by the end of the year. Superintendent Belson said that they will try but a lot happens over the summer.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto to accept the report and place on file:

Vote:

Yes: 6

No: 0

Absent: 1

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Shirley Carr. Mrs. Carr was a former account clerk at the vocational school and the wife of retired Medford Police Detective Patrick Carr.

School Committee Resolution

Be it resolved, that the Medford School Committee express its sincere condolences to the family of Robert Harrington. Mr. Harrington was a teacher at the Curtis-Tufts for many years.

A moment of silence was held.

On the motion of Mr. Ruggiero seconded by Mr. Ruseau to go to Executive Session at 9:53 p.m. for Negotiations and Legal Matters for the discussion of collective bargaining and an update on legal matters. The committee will not be returning to open session.

Roll Call:

Yea: 6 DiBenedetto, Kreatz, Mustone, Ruggiero, Ruseau, Van der Kloot

Nay: 0

Absent: 1 Burke

The meeting adjourned at 10:25 p.m.

Respectfully submitted:

Kathy Kreatz
Secretary